English Test Strategy v3

Supersedes English_Test_Decision_v2. One test, lowest cost, earliest deadline first. 8 November 2026

Decision

Take one IELTS Academic, computer-delivered, at a test centre:

- **Where:** British Council, Addis Ababa University (6 Kilo)
- **Fee:** ETB 32,800 (E1, ielts.org)
- **Target: 7.0 overall, no band below 6.5**
- **Do not take:**
  - **IELTS Online**: EDISS rejects it
  - **TOEFL**: more expensive and adds no programme
  - **PTE**: only AISS accepts it
  - **Duolingo**: unless CMU-Africa sends you its covered test

Total planned cost: ETB 32,800.

1. What each programme accepts (official rules)

Programme	IELTS Academic	IELTS Online	TOEFL iBT	PTE Academic	Duolingo (DET)	No test?	Ev.
Sweden (universityadmissions.se + SI)	–	–	–	–	–	**Yes**: a fully documented Ethiopian bachelor's meets the requirement	E1
AISS	**6.5, ≥ 5.5 each**	**Accepted**	92 / no section < 20 (before 21 Jan 2026); 4 / ≥ 4 each (after)	**62, ≥ 59 each**	Not listed	No	E1
EDISS	**6.5, no band < 6.0**	**Not accepted**	93 (before 21 Jan 2026); 4.5, no band < 4 (after); Home Edition not accepted	**Not accepted**	Not accepted	No (exemption only for degrees from AU, CA, NZ, UK, US, CH, EU/EEA)	E1
CMU-Africa	Recommended 6.5	–	Recommended 81–93 (pages differ)	Not listed	**120**; fee covered for first-time applicants applying by 15 Dec	**Optional by 15 Dec**; required after	E2
University of Manitoba	6.5	–	–	–	–	No	E1

Programme	IELTS Academic	IELTS Online	TOEFL iBT	PTE Academic	Duolingo (DET)	No test?	Ev.
Stipendium Hungaricum: ELTE / Szeged	ELTE: any B2 certificate / Szeged: 5.5	–	Szeged: 72	–	–	Possibly a medium-of-instruction letter (ask)	E1
CSC universities	Usually 6.0, or a medium-of-instruction letter	–	Varies	–	–	Often	E2
ICCR (India)	Per university	–	–	–	–	Often	E2
SMACCs, CDE, VLIR-UOS, IYT	Check each programme page	–	–	–	–	–	–

Validity: AISS counts IELTS, TOEFL and PTE results taken **no more than two years before studies begin** (E1). A December 2026 test is valid for every 2027 intake.

2. Why this is the lowest-cost combination

Option	Cost	Programmes covered	Verdict
IELTS Academic, computer, in-centre	**ETB 32,800**	AISS, EDISS, Manitoba, Szeged, most CSC universities; CMU-Africa if needed	**Take it**
IELTS Online	Availability in Ethiopia not verified	AISS only; **EDISS rejects it**	No
TOEFL iBT	US$185 (E1, ets.org)	Same as IELTS, but costs more	No
PTE Academic	Not verified in Ethiopia	AISS only among your priorities	No
DET	Covered by CMU-Africa for early first-time applicants (E2)	CMU-Africa only	Only if CMU sends it
IELTS UKVI	ETB 37,500	UK visas only (not needed)	No

3. Timing (earliest deadline first)

Results:

- Most computer-delivered IELTS results are issued **within 2 days**; about half within 1 day (E1, ielts.org global data).

Deadlines that drive the plan:

- EDISS needs the **Test Report Form number in the form by 12 Jan 2027**.
- AISS needs the result by **2 Feb 2027**.

If…	Book by	Test date	Why
Manitoba = **go**	**13 Nov**	**by 24 Nov**	Results in about 2 days, before the 1 Dec deadline
Manitoba = **no** (recommended unless a supervisor agrees this week)	**20 Nov**	**1–12 Dec**	Leaves time for one retake before EDISS's 12 Jan deadline

Retake buffer:

- If one band is below 6.5, ask the centre whether **IELTS One Skill Retake** is available for computer-delivered tests in Addis (it exists on ielts.org; local availability not confirmed).
- Otherwise retake the full test by **5 Jan**.

4. Four-week study plan (9 Nov – test week)

Daily: about 90 minutes on weekdays, 3 hours on Saturday and Sunday. The question bank is in `English_Test_and_Interview_Plan_v1`.

Week	Focus	Concrete tasks
1 (9–15 Nov)	Diagnostic + test format	One full official practice test **on a computer**. Record band per skill. Learn the computer interface (highlighting, word count). Book the test
2 (16–22 Nov)	Writing + Reading	3 Task 1 reports (charts, processes) and 3 Task 2 essays, timed (20 + 40 min). Rewrite each after feedback. Reading: 2 passages a day, 20 min each; practise True/False/Not Given and headings
3 (23–29 Nov)	Listening + Speaking	2 listening sections a day. Speaking: record Parts 1–3 daily on work, education and technology. Remove fillers; extend answers with reasons and examples
4 (30 Nov – test)	Full mocks	2 full timed mocks on a computer; review only your weakest skill; sleep and logistics (ID, arrival time)

Keep your passport valid and the name identical on the booking, test and every application.